Critical Thinking Rubric

This rubric will have four primary components; each will have equal weight and provide ample detail on how each student will be scored in the respective areas.

Component 1 – Research (Maximum Points = ___ Determined on criteria amounts)

Research

Criteria	Below Expectations 1 Point	Meets Expectations 2 Points	Exceeds Expectations 3 Points
Background	Demonstrates little or no research was conducted.	Demonstrates some background research was conducted and context somewhat accurate but not complete.	Demonstrates extensive background research was conducted and context thoroughly and accurately defined in own language.
Information Analysis	Search materials are outside the scope of the search query or too few and unsupported.	Evaluating multiple sources for reliability and relevance, cross-referencing information, and acknowledging potential biases.	Relying solely on the first few search results without considering the credibility or relevance of the sources.
Problem Definition	The research question does not articulate the scope of the problem and is too general to delineate a proper course of action.	Posing a vague research question without clearly defining the scope or purpose of the study.	Formulating a focused research question that addresses a specific issue and provides a clear direction for investigation.
Constructio n	No or minimal explanation components.	Listed elements or components, but the argument is vague or incomplete. Two or more references cited.	Detailed definition of components with importance with multiple cited references.
Data Interpretatio n	Using data that does not apply to the research question. Disregarding caveats in supporting material.	Providing a superficial interpretation of data without considering alternative explanations or potential confounding variables.	Analyzing data systematically, drawing conclusions based on evidence, and acknowledging any limitations in the data.

Analysis

Criteria	Below Expectations 1 Point	Meets Expectations 2 Points	Exceeds Expectations 3 Points
Data Analysis	Simply presenting raw data without any meaningful interpretation or analysis.	Providing some data analysis, but additional data is omitted or incorrectly interpreted.	Analyzing data and providing a clear interpretation of the results.
Context Analysis	Did not use the majority of concepts and terms in the correct context.	Used many concepts and terms in the proper context.	Consistently used concepts and terms in the proper context. .
Information Tools	Did not use any of the appropriate information, tools, techniques, or processes.	Used few appropriate information, tools, techniques, or processes	Used appropriate information, tools, techniques, or processes
Causal Analysis	Failing to show any understanding of concepts.	Showed an adequate understanding of concepts.	Showed an exceptional understanding of concepts.

Documentation

Criteria	Below Expectations 1 Point	Meets Expectations 2 Points	Exceeds Expectations 3 Points
Detail-Oriented Documentation	The document failed to demonstrate a cohesive thought process or logic.	The document demonstrated a relatively cohesive thought process or logic.	Demonstrates a high degree of cohesive thoughts and logic.
Clarity and Consistency	Creating documentation that is unclear, ambiguous, or inconsistent in terminology.	Ensuring that documentation is primarily clear, using consistent terminology, and presenting information with few ambiguous content areas.	Ensuring that documentation is clear, using consistent terminology, and presenting information logically and organized.
Professionalism	Many format or citation errors were noted.	Few errors in format or citation.	No format errors or citation errors.
Source Attribution	Failing to attribute sources or provide	Citing some sources incorrectly, or using	Demonstrating a thorough understanding

	references in documentation properly.	incorrect sources (or not using the best source).	of source attribution and incorporating correct (or the best) sources.
Grammar and Mechanics	Substantial grammatical, spelling, or punctuation errors were found.	Some grammatical, spelling, or punctuation errors were found.	No grammatical, spelling, or punctuation errors were found.

Presentation

Criteria	Below Expectations 1 Point	Meets Expectations 2 Points	Exceeds Expectations 3 Points
Subject Knowledge	Has a basic grasp of information or concepts and can answer basic questions about modification or option specifics.	Demonstrates a sufficient grasp of information or concepts. Answers questions but does not elaborate on answers.	Demonstrates proficient knowledge of information or concepts. Can answer all questions thoroughly.
Audience Adaptation	The audience has difficulty following the presentation, and the sequence is somewhat organized.	Information is presented in a logical sequence and is easy to follow	Data is presented logically, interestingly, and concisely and is easy to follow.
Clarity of Communication	Using jargon or complex language that is difficult for the audience to understand.	Communicating ideas clearly and concisely, using accessible language and supporting visual aids.	Achieving exceptional clarity by breaking down complex concepts, using relatable examples, and ensuring the audience can quickly grasp the key messages.
Elocution	The student's voice is low, and audience members have difficulty hearing the presentation.	The student's voice is clear and can be understood, and most of the presentation can be heard.	The student's voice is clear with precise pronunciation of terms and can be heard and understood by all audience members.